KEN DALA

THE KEN DALA COLLECTION / 2026

OMAN
BEYOND THE ORDINARY

A considered guide to the places, flavours and practical details that make a journey unforgettable.

THE COMPLETE TRAVELLER'S COMPANION

A premium companion for international travellers

START HERE

Your journey, curated.

Everything worth knowing before you go — designed to be saved, shared and taken along.

01 **The essentials**
Currency, language, time and entry

02 **When to visit**
Seasons, weather and what to pack

03 **Places to remember**
From Muscat to the mountains and desert

04 **Move beautifully**
Airports, city transport and intercity travel

05 **Live like a local**
Culture, dining, payments and useful apps

06 **Travel confidently**
Safety, checklists and essential links

01 / THE ESSENTIALS

Know before you go

A few practical details will make your arrival in Oman smoother.

Currency

Omani rial (OMR). Cards are widely accepted in cities; keep cash for traditional souqs and rural stops.

Language

Arabic is the official language. English is widely spoken in hotels, tourism venues and major shopping centres.

Time zone

Oman uses UTC+4 nationwide, year-round. Check the time difference with your home country.

Electricity

240V, 50Hz. Type G plugs are standard; bring an adapter if needed.

PASSPORT & ENTRY

Entry rules depend on nationality and stay length. Some visitors qualify for visa-free short stays, while others need a visa. Check Royal Oman Police eVisa guidance and confirm passport validity before departure.

02 / TIMING

Find your season.

Oman has hot coasts, cooler mountains and a seasonal monsoon in the south.



SPRING

MAR · MAY · 25·38°C

Warm days; explore early and pack sun protection.



SUMMER

JUN · AUG · 32·42°C+

Very hot in Muscat; Salalah turns green during khareef.



AUTUMN

SEP · NOV · 25·36°C

Coastal heat eases by November; great for road trips.



WINTER

DEC · FEB · 18·28°C

Ideal for Muscat, desert camping, wadis and hiking.

Approximate coastal temperatures; mountains and Dhofar differ.

03 / DESTINATIONS

Places worth the journey.

Build an itinerary around a feeling, not simply a checklist.

01

MUSCAT

Capital by the sea

Grand Mosque, Mutrah Souq, Royal Opera House and sea views. Allow 2–3 days.

02

NIZWA

Historic heart of Oman

Nizwa Fort, souq, old villages and mountain gateways. Allow 2–3 days.

03

WAHIBA SANDS

Golden desert horizons

Sunset dunes, stargazing and desert camps. Stay 1–2 nights.

03 / DESTINATIONS

Beyond the icons.

Build an itinerary around a feeling, not simply a checklist.

04

JEBEL AKHDAR

The green mountain

Terraced villages, rose gardens and canyon viewpoints; 4WD access rules apply.

05

WADI SHAB

Turquoise canyon pools

Scenic hiking, swimming and rocky canyon scenery; check rainfall and water conditions.

06

SALALAH & MUSANDAM

Coastal contrasts

Green khareef hills in Dhofar; dramatic fjords and dhow cruises in Musandam.

04 / ARRIVALS

Arrive with ease.

The main airports and practical entry points for exploring Oman.

MCT	Muscat International	Oman's main international gateway and capital airport.
SLL	Salalah Airport	Gateway to Dhofar and the khareef season.
OHS	Sohar Airport	Limited regional and seasonal flight services.
KHS	Khasab Airport	Access to Musandam; check current schedules.
DQM	Duqm Airport	Gateway to Al Wusta and the central coast.
MCT / SLL	Muscat / Salalah	Main gateways for international arrivals.

Flight planning: Routes and seasonal schedules change. Check Muscat and Salalah for the best connections to your itinerary.

05 / MOBILITY

The art of getting around.

Road trips are central to Oman; plan distances and terrain thoughtfully.

In the city

Muscat has taxis and selected bus services. Confirm fares and pickup points; payment methods vary.

Between cities

Domestic flights connect selected regions. Mwasalat operates intercity buses on certain routes; book ahead.

Airport transfers

Use licensed taxis or pre-booked hotel transfers. Confirm pickup details before arrival.

Road trips

Mountain and desert routes may need a 4WD, experienced driver and weather checks. Distances between fuel stops can be long.

06 / SPENDING

Money, made simple.

Pay confidently while allowing for differences between city and countryside.

Cards & cash

Cards are common in cities and hotels. Keep Omani rial cash for souqs, rural cafés and remote areas.

ATMs & banks

Major banks include Bank Muscat, NBO, Sohar International and Bank Dhofar. Check your own bank's fees.

Exchange wisely

Use reputable banks or exchange counters. Review live rates and avoid costly conversion into your home currency.

Budget planning

Costs vary between Muscat, resorts and remote tours. Budget for transport, guides, activities and seasonal prices.

A SMART TRAVEL HABIT

Some small businesses accept cash only. Carry an international card and some Omani rials as backup.

07 / LOCAL LIFE

The culture of welcome.

Discover the generous hospitality and traditions of Oman.

Hospitality & respect

Omani hospitality often includes coffee and dates. Ask before photographing people or private homes.

Useful local words

Marhaba = hello • Shukran = thank you • Na’am / La = yes / no in Arabic. English is widely spoken.

Food worth travelling for

Try shuwa, majboos, grilled seafood, dates and Omani halwa. Ask about ingredients.

Heritage & customs

Dress modestly at mosques and traditional sites. Respect Ramadan customs and local traditions.

08 / TOOLKIT

Your pocket concierge.

Download the essentials and save offline details before your trip.

NAVIGATION

Google Maps · Apple Maps

Download offline maps for remote roads and wadis.

LANGUAGE

Google Translate

Save Arabic for offline assistance.

TRANSPORT

Mwasalat · local taxi apps

Check route coverage, pickup locations and fares.

AIR TRAVEL

Oman Air · SalamAir

Check schedules, baggage rules and flight notifications.

STAYS & EXPERIENCES

Your booking provider's app

Save hotel addresses, tour vouchers and guide contacts offline.

CONNECTIVITY

Carrier app • eSIM provider

Check Omantel / Ooredoo roaming, SIM and eSIM options.

09 / ESSENTIALS

Travel with confidence.

Preparation matters when travelling through mountains, wadis and deserts.

1

Emergency

Dial 9999 for emergency assistance in Oman.

2

Documents

Carry your passport, insurance, booking details and offline copies; check entry requirements.

3

Wadi safety

Avoid wadis during rain or flash-flood warnings; use qualified guides for remote adventures.

4

Health

Pack prescriptions in original packaging and check medicine-import rules.

5

Connectivity

Coverage may be weak in remote areas; save maps and share your plans.

6

Road awareness

Avoid night drives on remote roads; check vehicle, tyres and fuel stops.

10 / DEPARTURE

The final checklist.

A beautifully simple way to leave nothing important behind.

- [ ] Passport and current entry requirements checked
- [ ] Flights, hotel addresses and airport transfers saved
- [ ] Travel insurance and emergency contacts stored
- [ ] Bank cards, some Omani rials and backup funds ready
- [ ] Offline maps, translation tools and booking apps installed
- [ ] Modest clothing, sun protection and walking shoes
- [ ] Power adapter, charger and medication packed
- [ ] Weather, transport and attraction opening hours rechecked

For a smoother trip: Keep copies of important documents offline and share your itinerary with someone you trust.

11 / INSPIRATION

Make it your own.

Three ways to explore Oman, from city culture to dramatic landscapes.

5 DAYS

The Muscat escape

Muscat · Mutrah · Nizwa

A coastal city stay paired with culture and Omani dining.

8 DAYS

Desert & mountains

Muscat · Nizwa · Jebel Akhdar · Wahiba Sands

A scenic adventure; allow for long drives and 4WD access.

10 DAYS

Coast & heritage

Muscat · Sur · Salalah

Coastal towns, frankincense heritage and southern scenery in one journey.

12 / TRUSTED SOURCES

Useful links, always.

Entry rules, schedules and park access can change. Confirm before travel.

ENTRY & VISAS

egov.kz • gov.kz

TOURISM & DESTINATIONS

experienceoman.om

AIR TRAVEL

airastana.com • flyarystan.com

RAIL TRAVEL

mwasalat.om

WEATHER

met.gov.om

EMERGENCIES

9999 — national emergency number

Editorial note: This guide offers general information, not a visa guarantee or live quotation. Confirm current requirements for your passport, itinerary and travel dates.

KEN DALA

THE WORLD IS YOURS TO DISCOVER.

Extraordinary journeys begin with curiosity — and the freedom to travel well.

KEN DALA / CURATED TRAVEL EXPERIENCES